

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1991-11-18

To the followers of bahá'u'lláh in every land

1 dear bahá'í friends,

2 A time of challenge for the stalwart upholders of the cause of god has

3 now come upon us at the very moment when the world is grappling with
tremendous problems, moral, social, economic and ecological. The bahá'í

4 community has grown in size and influence to the point where it is put to

5 the test on all sides and at all levels. The opportunities are immense but we

6 now face the question of whether to push forward with all speed, or to hold back
because the resources available to us are inadequate for the purpose.

in lands where people have accepted the faith in large numbers, the

7 process of economic and social development, linked with the establishment,
consolidation and strong functioning of local Spiritual Assemblies,

8 is attaining ever greater importance and is placing upon the international

9 resources of the faith a heavy demand for manpower and finance. in the

10 countries of the former eastern bloc the need for assistance in the form

11 of bahá'í literature, pioneers, traveling teachers, the establishment of local

12 centers, is made the more urgent by the extraordinary receptivity to the message of
bahá'u'lláh shown by the spiritually thirsty populations. The

13 opportunities for the promotion of the cause of god in these areas cannot

14 be allowed to go unheeded.

15 At the national level, the structure of bahá'í communities is growing in

16 complexity as the number of believers rises, and National Spiritual Assem-

17 blies are being increasingly invited by national governments and nongovernmental
organizations to offer advice and assistance in upholding human

18 rights, in safeguarding the environment, in promoting moral education,

19 and in overcoming the ravages of prejudice and the rising tide of lawlessness-120.1

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1986–1992 • The Six Year Plan

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ness which are undermining the social structure. internationally a parallel

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process is taking place.

At the world center itself, the construction work on the mount carmel

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projects has begun, preparing facilities befitting the central institutions of

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the Administrative order of bahá'u'lláh for that time when they will have

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to shoulder the tremendous responsibilities that will be thrust upon them as

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the lesser peace begins to be established in the world.

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over the past four years there was a steady increase in the contributions

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of the friends worldwide to the international funds of the faith, and it had

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been our hope and expectation that this rise would continue and even be accelerated in the current year. but since last riṣván, on the contrary, there

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has been a sudden drop in contributions both to the international funds

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as a whole and to the Arc projects fund, creating a crisis which must be

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promptly overcome. in response to the growing needs of the teaching work

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and the Arc projects, we have for several years been drastically cutting the

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expenditure of the world center, canceling or postponing many activities

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which, although valuable, cannot be pursued under the present condition

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of shortage of funds. This process cannot be taken much further without

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seriously hampering the ability of the world center to function at the level

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which the interests of the faith require.

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if the financial needs of this year and those immediately ahead are to be

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met, the contributions to the international funds of the cause must, far

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from decreasing, be substantially increased.

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Such an effort will call for sacrifice on the part of individual believers and

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also for the diversion of funds from those local and national projects which are not essential. we are confident that the friends will respond to this call, as

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they did to the crisis precipitated by the iranian revolution in 1979 when, at

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one moment, 61% of the income of the international funds was cut off.

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This is the immediate need. beyond this there is, we believe, a worldwide

148 need for appreciation of this basic principle of our faith: that contributing
149 to the fund should constitute an integral part of the spiritual life of every
150 bahá'í and be regarded as the fulfillment of a fundamental spiritual obliga-
151 tion. in too many countries we have encountered a reluctance among the
152 teachers of the cause to include, in their presentation of the Teachings,
153 support of the fund as a natural part of bahá'í life. in the kitáb-i-Aqdas,
154 bahá'u'lláh more than once refers to the necessity for combining spiritual
155 and material means in achieving the purposes of the faith. Shoghi effendi,
156 for his part, referred to the fund as the life-blood of the cause.^{120.4}

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121 m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

122 26we urge all the friends to give deep thought to the importance of sup-
123 porting the cause financially and to the effect that bahá'í activities have on
124 the condition of the entire human race.

125 it is our fervent prayer at the Sacred Threshold that bahá'u'lláh will in-
126 spire his devoted followers in every land to arise unitedly in the service of
127 his cause and will reward their sacrifices with an outpouring of heavenly
128 bounties.

129 with loving bahá'í greetings,

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Message on the Day of the Covenant

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]